SECOND WATCH: ADMIRAL'S QUICK-START

Everything you need to run a first session in about two hours: what to prepare, a ten-minute rules talk, and a ready-to-run first mission set after Wolf 359. The full rules are in Second Watch: Tabletop Rules.

BEFORE THE SESSION

- **Pick the profile and power level.** For a first game: Fleet profile, Line level (800 FC), 2–3 captains.
- **Ships.** Each captain builds a ship in Starship Yard under Build rules → Line, or starts from the cruiser or science template (both under 800 FC). In Launch → Second Watch, they pick a command style and print the record sheet (two pages).
- **Print for the table:** one record sheet per ship, one campaign log per ship, and one set of opponent cards. Blank and sample copies are in the Library.
- **Bring:** three six-sided dice per player, pencils, and a ruler in inches if a fight breaks out. Tokens or 50 mm prints work as miniatures.
- **Optional:** open Launch → Second Watch → Run a mission on a laptop or tablet in the middle of the table. It rolls scenes in the open and checks each ship against the orders.

THE TEN-MINUTE RULES TALK

Read or paraphrase this to the table:

1. **You are captains.** Your crew are skilled professionals; you decide what they attempt. I am the Admiral: I give the orders and play everyone else.
2. **One roll.** Roll two dice and add the roll bonus from your sheet for the department doing the work. Meet the target: 6 is routine, 8 standard, 10 hard, 12 heroic. Your bonus never goes above +4.
3. **Your ship matters.** A facility that fits the job gives advantage (roll three dice, keep the best two). A missing system gives disadvantage (keep the worst two).
4. **Doubles.** Double six is a success with a bonus. Double one always fails and brings a complication.
5. **Resolve.** Each captain has 3 Resolve per mission. Spend one to reroll, or to add +1 after seeing the dice.
6. **Fights.** If talking fails, we put ships on the table and use the Skirmish rules on page 1 of your sheet.

FIRST MISSION: THE SALVAGE LINE

Setting (2367, Starfleet skin). One week after the Battle of Wolf 359. One Borg cube destroyed 39 of the 40 ships sent against it. The fleet is rebuilding fast, and the debris field is still full of wreckage, survivors' logs, and Borg technology that must not fall into the wrong hands.

Read aloud (the Admiral's orders):

> Captains, the Wolf 359 debris field is now a restricted zone. Your task force will recover the flight recorders from three of our lost ships, search for survivors in sealed compartments, and collect or destroy any Borg material you find. Ferengi and independent salvagers have already been seen at the edge of the field. You are authorized to warn them off. You are not authorized to start a war over scrap. Admiral out.

Requirements. Sensors and shuttles or small craft. **Helpful:** fabrication shops, damage control center, brig.

SCENE 1: INTO THE FIELD (SCIENCE 8)

The wreckage is dense and some of it is still powered. Each captain chooses a sector. Success: the ship finds a flight recorder and a safe approach. Failure: the ship drifts into a live plasma conduit and marks 2 Hull boxes, but finds the recorder anyway.

SCENE 2: SEALED COMPARTMENT (ENGINEERING 10, OR OPERATIONS 9 WITH A SHUTTLE)

A saucer section has a sealed compartment with faint life signs. Cutting in risks breaching it. Success: four survivors recovered. Failure: the compartment holds, but the rescue takes the rest of the day (lose 1 Supply). On a critical success, one survivor saw something about the cube that Starfleet Intelligence will want.

SCENE 3: BORG MATERIAL (SCIENCE 9, THEN A CAPTAIN'S CHOICE)

One ship finds an intact piece of Borg technology, still faintly active. Roll to contain it safely. Then the captain decides: destroy it now, or bring it home for study. Bringing it home earns +1 Reputation, but the Admiral secretly notes it: it comes back in a later mission.

SCENE 4: THE SALVAGERS (COMMAND 9 OR DIPLOMACY 9)

A Ferengi salvage ship and two independent haulers are cutting up a hull. They insist it is legal salvage. Success: they leave peacefully, or agree to hand over anything Starfleet needs. Failure: the largest hauler

opens fire. Run a short Skirmish with the Raider opponent card (one per two player ships), ending when the raiders lose half their Hull.

Twist (Admiral only). One of the flight recorders shows a ship that was ordered away from the battle before it started. Who gave that order is a campaign hook, not something to resolve tonight.

Debrief. At least three scenes succeeded: 160 FC and 2 Reputation per ship, and 1 Renown per captain. Two: 80 FC, no Reputation. Fewer: no pay; the Admiral explains what Starfleet Command thinks of the task force. Each ship marks one completed mission on its campaign log.

Generic skin version. Same structure: the Gate Collapse left a fleet wrecked at a dead jump point. Replace the Borg material with an alien artifact found in the wreckage, and the Ferengi with a corporate salvage crew holding a writ from the seceded shipyards.

AFTER THE SESSION

- Fill in the campaign logs: FC, Reputation, Renown, damage carried, and the twist.
- Repairs cost 5 FC per Hull box and 20 FC per systems box. Unrepaired damage carries over.
- Ask the table which thread they want to pull next: the missing ship from the flight recorder, the Borg material, or the salvagers. That is your second mission.
- Note what felt too easy or too hard, and share it with the person running the playtest.